

Foursquare Global Distinctives

Overview

The U.S Foursquare Church has two reference points for Identity: six Global Distinctives and five Identity Keystones (Foursquare Identity #2). The Foursquare Global Council, comprised of leaders from more than 70 nations, gathered in Phoenix, Ariz., in 2012 to answer the question, “What resonates deeply within us about ‘who we are’ despite our differences across many nations, languages, and peoples?”

To arrive at these foundational principles, Foursquare leaders pursued collaborative and unified intercession to hear the voice of the Lord for the Foursquare global family. They discerned and developed the six Global Distinctives that the Foursquare global community would hold in common. The global Foursquare community agreed that while Foursquare churches may be flexible to fit the cultures and communities where they minister, they are always in alignment with these Global Distinctives:

1. Kingdom Partnerships

We will work alongside other Christians and churches. We will be a distinct movement, but will also hold a collegial spirit and maintain a helpful and cooperative posture with whom we can partner in mission.

2. Sound Doctrine

Our Declaration of Faith of The Foursquare Church will guide our practice, church polity, and call of believers into the work of the Kingdom. It will be a biblical statement, apply to all members, and be the Declaration of Faith for all churches and all member nations. Its roots are deeply rooted in the sole source of spiritual authority – the Word of God.

3. Empowering Leadership

According to God’s gifting and calling, we will intentionally prepare and release men and women across generations and cultures into all positions of leadership and areas of ministry.

4. Family Relationships

We will relate to each other with love in our Global Family. We acknowledge that relationships are the heart of God's Kingdom and will extend grace to fellow believers through ministry, cooperation and mutual submission in our global church.

5. Spirit Empowerment

As a Spirit-filled movement, we will consistently minister the Baptism in the Holy Spirit, and teach and encourage believers to fully express the gifts of the Spirit in their daily lives. We totally submit ourselves in obedience to the Spirit's use of our lives and miraculous works in our day.

6. Shared Mission

We will focus our mission and ministry efforts on multiplying disciples, leaders, churches and national movements. Holding to God's passion for the lost, we will seek a movement of evangelism, mercy ministries, contextualized church planting, and mobilizing indigenous believers in ministry among all peoples.

Interview Questions

- In your own words, please explain each of the six Global Distinctive of The Foursquare Church.

Pastoral Considerations/Application

- We want ministers who wholeheartedly embody and champion all six of the Global Distinctives in life and practice.